TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, MAY 12 , 2021
6:30 PM

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Goette called the meeting to order at 6:31 pm

   Present were Mayor Beth Goette, Dana Williams, David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, John Henry, Brooks Barbaree and Ed Drohan. Staff in attendance were: Finance Administrator, Tomi Rikkinen; Utility Billing Manager, Katina Spaulding; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Town Clerk, Deatre Denion, Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman and Police Chief, Sean Clayton. Absent was Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Goette ask for a motion to pass the agenda. **Council Member Williams made the motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of April 14, 2021; April 19, 2021 and May 3, 2021

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the previous meeting minutes for April 14th, April 19th and May 3rd, 2021. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the minutes with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Recognition of Tommy Ingrim**

Consent Agenda:

6. **Approve of City of Savannah's Pretreatment Agreement**

7. **Approval of County-City Agreement for Drug Enforcement Activities**

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the Consent Agenda. **Council Member Williams made the motion to approve with a second from Council Member Crenshaw.** Council Member Drohan asked if Town Attorney Barrow reviewed the agreements. Town Attorney Barrow stated he had and there was nothing he saw to be an issue. **The motion passed unanimously.**

Discussion Agenda

8. **Planning and Zoning:**

   a. **Petitioner:** Gregory Thompson
   Request: Fence Height Variance
   Parcel Involved: 3-0003-03-007
   Location: 3009 Young Ave
   P & Z approved unanimously

Gregory Thompson was in attendance to explain his petition. Mr. Thompson is requesting a variance for his fence height. Town Clerk Denion explained Mr. Thompson already has a building permit to build an addition to the home. They then decided to add a fence. Mr. Thompson has built the panels for the fence but it has not been installed. When he measured the height for the fence application it was realized it is 7 feet in height. That is not an issue for the back of the fence but the sides can be no taller than 6 feet. Council Member Crenshaw asked why so tall. Mr. Thompson stated they have issues with kids coming over the current fence and stealing. **Council Member Williams made the motion to approve the variance request with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Department Report –** Written Reports Submitted

   by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police
   Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman -
   Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Fire Chief Bateman announced the old fire truck is in the shop getting refurbished. Council Member Henry stated he wanted to say what a great job Fire/EMS did when he had an emergency at his home recently.

10. **Legal Report – Town Attorney –**

Town Attorney Barrow had provided a recommended change for the Employee Handbook by email. Council Member **Crenshaw made the motion to accept the recommended change for the Employee Handbook with a second by Council Member Williams. The motion passed five to one with Council Member Henry opposing.**

11. **Mayor and Council –**

Mayor Goette provided a handout on ESPLOST and TSPLOST. ESPLOST is to be on November ballot.

Mayor Goette informed Council she met with Patti Lyons about reopening the Senior Center on June 1. Ms. Lyon explained all staff, volunteers and clients have been vaccinated. They will be cleaning and reorganize the facility. Mayor Goette explained she did request the current list of clients attending. She was told about 30 to 32 clients attend but Ms. Lyon will provide a breakdown of number of Thunderbolt Seniors who participate.

a) **Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan**

Council Member Drohan wanted to bring attention to an email he sent to Council on April 19th future infrastructure needs. There needs to be a move to have a Town wide discussion on conservation. The Town has to either severely revisit cost structure or do something functionally to met the reductions from the Floridian Aquifer.

Council Member Williams spoke on meeting with Ms. Chappell and other neighbors in the area. **Council Member Williams made a motion to have Town Attorney to create an ordinance to ban smoking in all public parks.** Council Member Crenshaw asked to include all public buildings. It was explained that is already in effect. Council Member Crenshaw stated it should be a ban on all smoking products in the public parks.

Council Member Ward asked about enforcement. Council Member Williams stated he was about to get to that. Mayor Goette stated signs should be added. Council Member Williams explains he spoke with Chief Clayton about enforcement. Chief Clayton stated this would give the officers and opportunity to approach people in the park if they are smoking and address other problems. Other residential request, are to have no dogs and remove the Banet Plant. Council Member Williams spoke with Public Works Manager Crosby about new equipment or at least repair current recreational equipment. Funding may be an issue but Public Works Manager will look into options. There was a concern with unsupervised children and wondered if there could be an age limit for unsupervised children. Town Attorney Barrow stated he did not know if there are current regulations on unsupervised age limit for children but would look into it. Council Member Drohan sited DEFAC guidelines for unsupervised children ages. Council Member Henry stated the DEFAC guidelines are for children being left at home, not the same as in public buildings and parks. Council Member Crenshaw stated he agrees the Town should not get into legislating parenting but the Town can put up a sign limiting unsupervised children age requirement. Council Member Crenshaw added roaches and marijuana to the smoking ban. Council Member Williams continued on about Cesaroni and Nellie Parks being more versatile and offering other recreational sports, such as tennis. Council Member Drohan stated he spoke with a friend of his, who came over and looked at options to use for recreation. One of the ideas is a court play pickle ball. He also recommended other options such as shuffle board. He offered to have his court person to come and look at the area to see what needs to be done. These lands are underutilized. **Council Member Ward seconded the motion by Council Member Williams to draft an ordinance banning tobacco products. Then motion passed unanimously.**

Mayor Goette announced Town Hall will be closed for Memorial Day, May 31, 2021.

Mayor Goette asked for a motion to move into Executive Session. **Council Member Williams made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

12. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal and/or Personnel matters.

    Mayor Goette asked for a motion to return to the regular meeting. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

    Mayor Goette presented Tommy Ingrim with a plaque for his many years of service to the Town of Thunderbolt.

13. **Adjournment:**

    Mayor Goette asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. Council Member **Williams made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.** The meeting adjourned at 7:19 pm.

~~Mayor, Beth E. Goette~~ Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion